

Poverty and Food Security Analysis

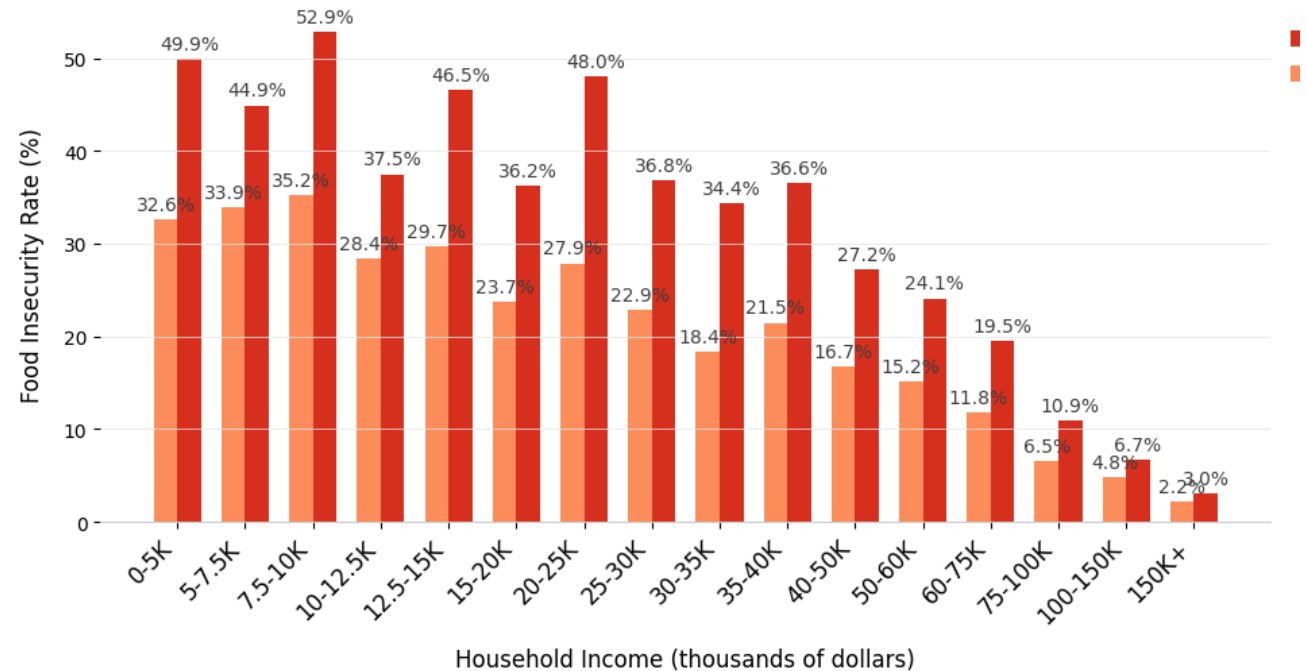
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Data 608 Story 6

Food Insecurity Rates By Income and Age Group

- Food insecurity is a real concern for everyone but much more so at lower income brackets.
- The rate of food-insecure children is significantly higher than for adults across all income brackets.
- While there is a clear trend in that higher salary brackets are less likely to be food-insecure, the rate is relatively stable for all brackets below \$30,000.

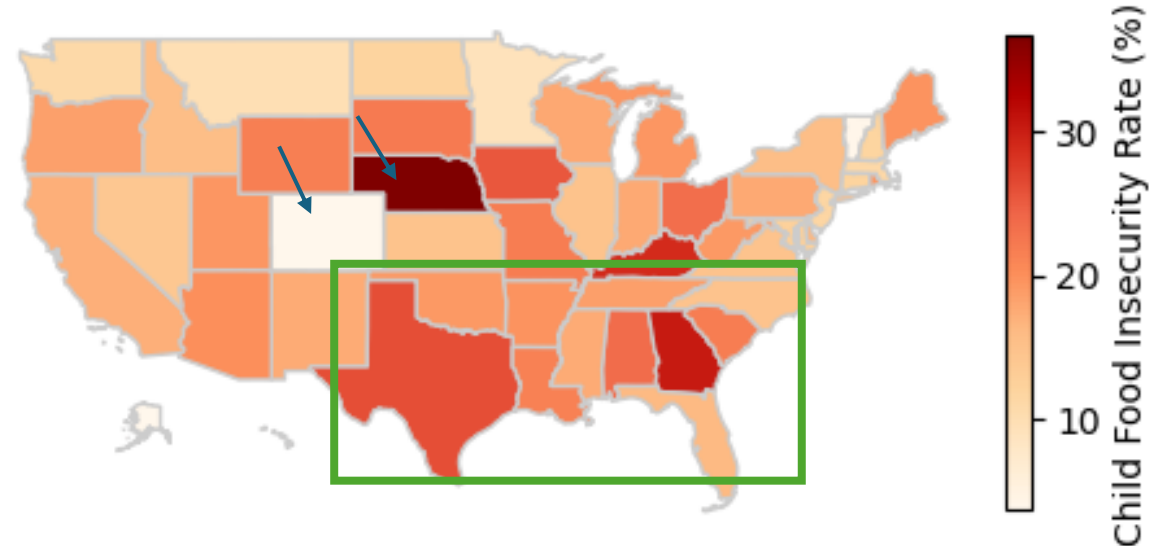
Disproportionate Rates of Food Insecurity Between Children and Adult
(National Average, 2023)



Child Food Insecurity Rate

- Food insecurity exists throughout the nation; however, the US South seems to be the most susceptible and the children there can most benefit from intervention
- Additionally, Nebraska seems to be a major outlier in terms of food-insecure children and should be looked at deeper to try to replicate other states.
- Colorado has the fewest food-insecure children. It should be used a case study in decreasing food insecurity.

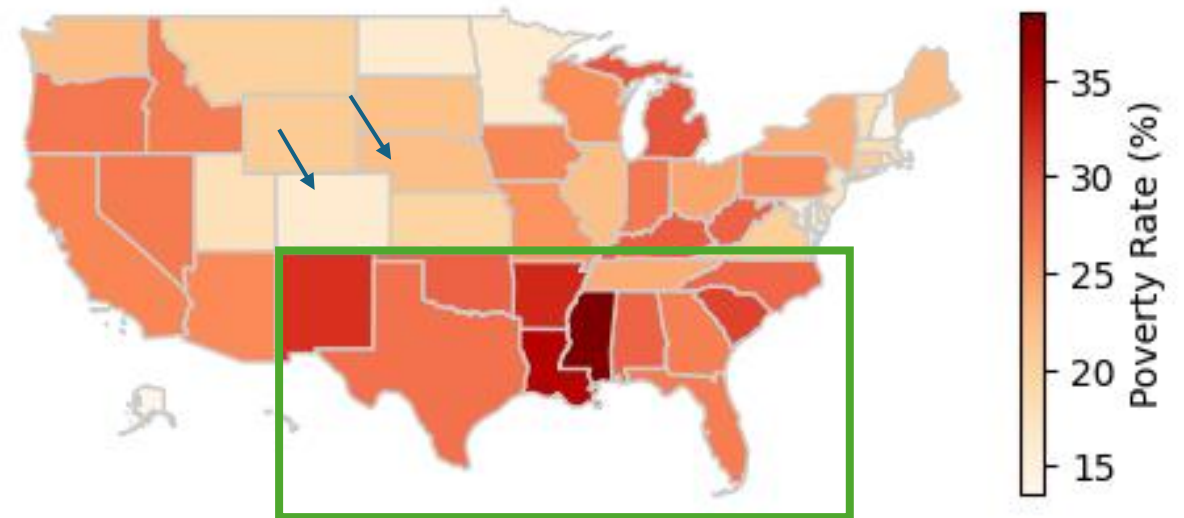
Child Food Insecurity Rate by State (2023)



Poverty Rate

- As with child food insecurity rates, the US South has the highest rates of poverty.
- Interestingly, the individual states with the highest food insecurity rates do not necessarily match the ones with the highest poverty rates. However, the overall region is the same.
- Colorado stands out with having one of the lowest poverty rates, explaining its extremely low child food insecurity rate.
- Nebraska has a relatively low poverty rate, making it imperative to find out why its food insecurity rate is so high

Poverty Rate by State (2023)



Takeaways

- Food insecurity remains a major concern in this country in particular child food insecurity.
- Income under \$30,000 is a huge indicator of food insecurity.
- The US South as a region has a disproportionately higher poverty rate and a correspondingly higher food insecurity rate, combatting the poverty rate should decrease food insecurity. This is true on the regional level but not on a state level specifically, meaning efforts to change this need to focus on a region.
- There are some outliers on the state level as well, in particular, Nebraska. Despite its relatively low poverty rate, its food insecurity rate is extremely high. Determining the cause of this and modeling itself after some other states can help there.